

Resume:

Pacifique Liyana Ishimwe

Senior Product Manager:Program & Product Leader | Multi-Country Digital Operations | Budget & Portfolio Management

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Skills

Experience

Profile:

Product manager with experience managing multi-country digital initiatives across remote teams. Proven track record overseeing budgets, aligning cross-functional teams, and building and executing product roadmaps and translating strategy into operational execution. Experienced in stakeholder management across government, telecom, and development partners, with a focus on scalable systems and measurable impact

Product & Digital Systems Leadership

Digital Strategy & Implementation Planning | Multi-Country Program Coordination | Government & Stakeholder Engagement | Budget Oversight & Financial Tracking | Risk & Dependency Management | Monitoring, Evaluation & Learning Alignment | Cross-Functional Team Leadership | Human-Centered Design & Service Design | Data-Informed Decision Making | Digital Platform & Public Infrastructure Optimization

Delivery Frameworks & Operational Systems

Human-Centered & Participatory Design Approaches | Agile & Structured Delivery Models | Portfolio Tracking & Reporting Systems | Performance Measurement & Analytics | Knowledge & Workflow Management

Tools: Tableau, , Linear, Asana, Confluence, lookstudio, Google Analytics, SQL

Gassarro/ Founder,Operations Lead

July 2025 - present, Zambia,

Experience and outcomes:

I established and now oversee end-to-end business operations at Gassarro, designing the organizational structure, operational workflows, and performance management systems required for scale. I introduced KPIs and reporting dashboards to provide real-time visibility into execution, standardized core processes through formal SOPs, and implemented automation to reduce operational friction. I also lead and mentor a cross-functional team, embedding clear ownership and accountability across functions.

Impact

This has strengthened execution discipline and reduced key-person dependency, creating a more resilient operating model. Streamlined workflows and automation improved delivery speed without compromising quality, while structured performance tracking enabled data-informed decision-making and sustainable growth..

Viamo / Platform Manager

March 2023 - February 2025, Zambia

Experience and Outcomes

At Viamo, I led a national digital engagement platform serving over 2 million users, driving growth, monetization, and cross-sector partnerships across health, agriculture, and civic education. I co-designed large-scale IVR programs with USAid, CIMMYT, Unicef, and the government. I also piloted and launched the world's first offline Generative AI assistant. I

restructured engagement and revenue systems to improve sustainability and scalability.

Impact

This work drove sustained platform growth in Zambia while improving financial performance and user engagement. The 'Ask Viamo Anything' pilot that I implemented from inception to commercial launch generated nearly 90,000 user queries during its initial phase, demonstrating demand for AI-supported information access in low-connectivity settings. Through co-designed health programming, over 50,000 users experienced improved access to essential services, with retention rates exceeding 75 percent. The revised revenue

Brightlife by Finca / Product and Marketing manager

May 2022 - November 2022, Uganda

Experience and Outcomes

At Brightlife, I spearheaded the expansion of digital and commercial offerings, directing the end-to-end launch of new products beyond solar solutions, including a bundled clean cookstove and smartphone for low-income households. I championed a youth agent program to strengthen last-mile distribution and orchestrated the introduction of new regional markets, aligning cross-functional teams across engineering, sales, and external partners to operationalize initiatives at scale.

Impact

These initiatives drove measurable outcomes: three new products reached over 5,000 households, generating \$250K+ in revenue while reducing indoor air pollution. The youth agent program mobilized 70+ agents, increasing partner engagement by 40%, and the marketing infrastructure I established boosted digital product engagement by 40%.

Engie energy access / Product and Marketing manager

Oct 2020 - November 2022, Zambia

Experience and Outcomes

Led product innovation and market expansion for PayGo solar solutions, focusing on affordability and accessibility for off-grid communities. I launched new bundled products, including solar energy packages with satellite TV, piloted inverter-powered solar business systems, and tested solar-powered irrigation solutions for smallholder farmers. I also directed large-scale solar initiatives for SMEs, schools, and clinics, and developed a customized CRM, pricing strategy, and UX training library to support the Zambian team.

Impact

These initiatives expanded product reach and improved operational efficiency: solar and TV bundles reached new households, inverter-powered systems pilots scaled SME access, and CRM and training tools achieved 100% adoption by the team. Field improvements for a biogas digester pilot enhanced usability, while budget tracking mechanisms reduced costs without compromising quality. Product launches were closely aligned with local market needs, driving adoption and sustainable impact.

UNZA (The University of Zambia /Bachelors of Social
Work| Focused in sustainable Development and the environment.
Mar 2013 - Nov 2017, Lusaka Zambia

COURSES:

Predictive Project Management course by the [Project Management Institute](#) (PMI)

Panelist, Africa SBS Workshop: Presented on innovative, offline-first digital solutions designed to drive social behavior change and foster digital inclusion among last-mile communities, highlighting the critical role of community-led co-design in ensuring adoption and impact.

- GDDF Panel Speaker: Piloted the world's first USSD Voice-Generative AI digital assistant that operates without internet access and shared insights on designing inclusive, offline AI solutions for last mile communities.

- Collaborative Case Studies: Partnering with GSMA and other organizations to document and lead a case study to share Impact stories of the Gen-AI initiative in Zambia published by GSMA: [GSMA report](#).

Available upon request.

**Education , Thought
Leadership & Public
Engagement:**

References: